

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: October 2025. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Before overheads, so this is not profit. Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

- September 2025

Locked

September 2025 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2025). These numbers won't change.
- October 2025

Locked

October 2025 is locked (closed 4 Nov 2025). These numbers won't change.
- October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

October's jobs made \$49,446 gross margin (38.4%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$9,638 and overheads \$57,980, leaving (\$18,172) profit before tax ((14.1%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 52.5% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$49,446
Technician wages and on-costs	\$46,800
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$37,162
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$9,638
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$39,808
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$57,980
Profit before tax (the P&L)	(\$18,172)
Revenue	\$128,898
Gross margin on jobs, %	38.4%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(14.1%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	52.5%

Type of job: All jobs

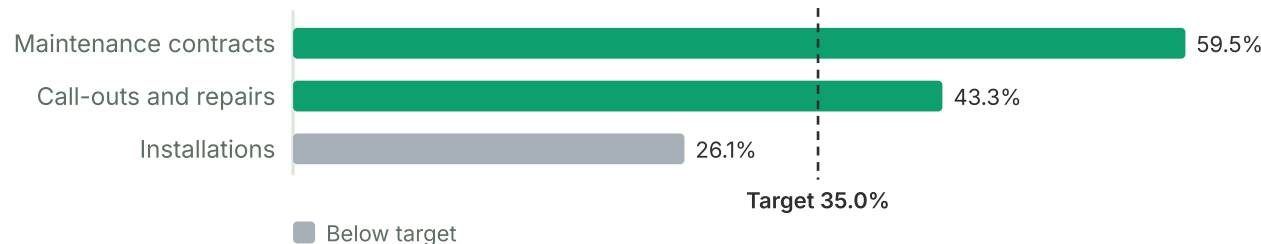
Job gross margin, October · All jobs

38.4%

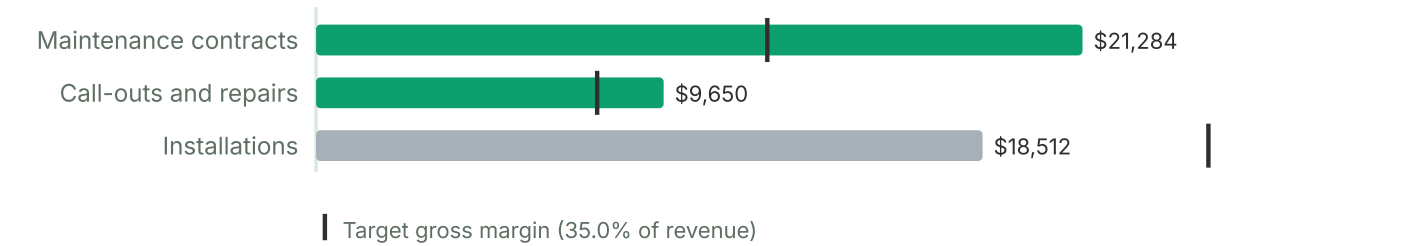
September 37.6%

Job gross margin by type of job, October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In October maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 26.1% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.3% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 52.5% just to cover overheads.

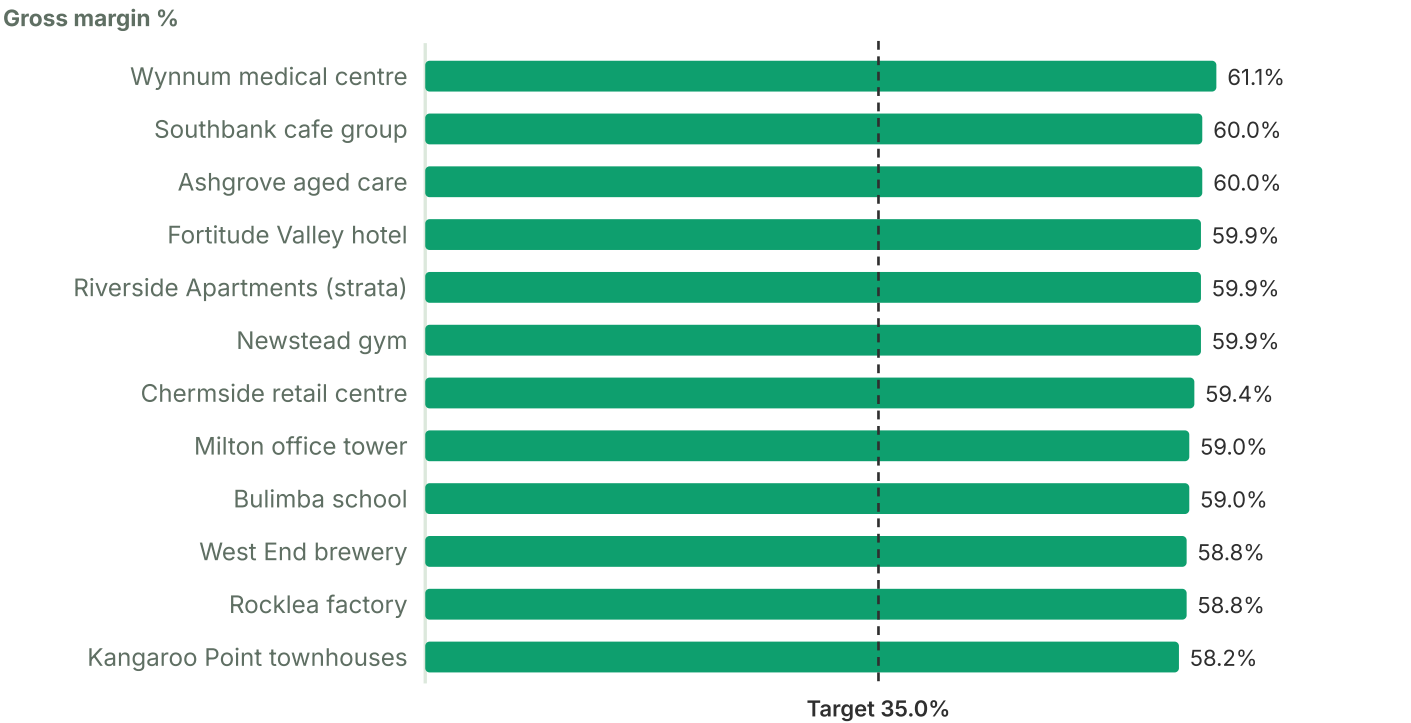
What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, the most profitable work you do. Installations: 26.1% gross margin, below the 52.5% needed to cover overheads.

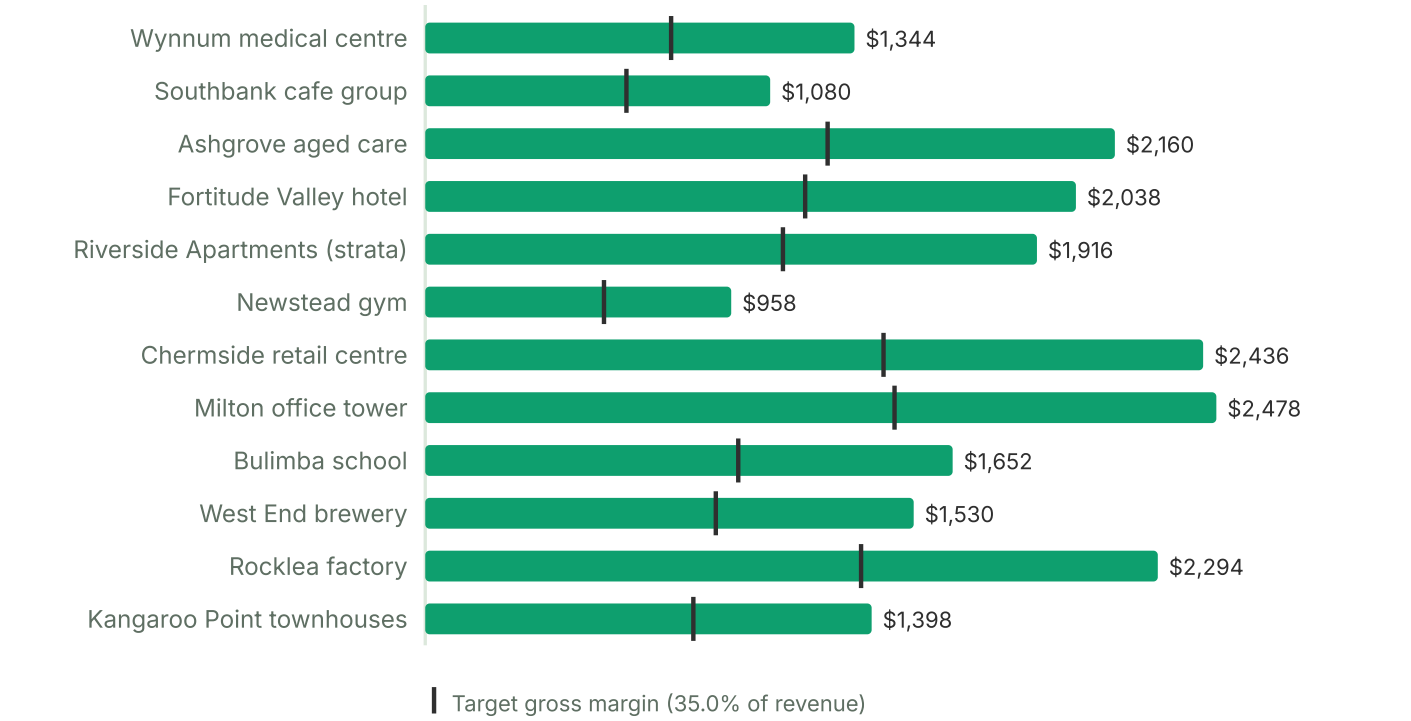
Type of job: Maintenance contracts



Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, October 2025



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The Kangaroo Point townhouses contract: 58.2% gross margin, 5.8 points clear of the 52.5% overheads need. Maintenance contracts overall: 59.5% gross margin.

Type of job: Installations

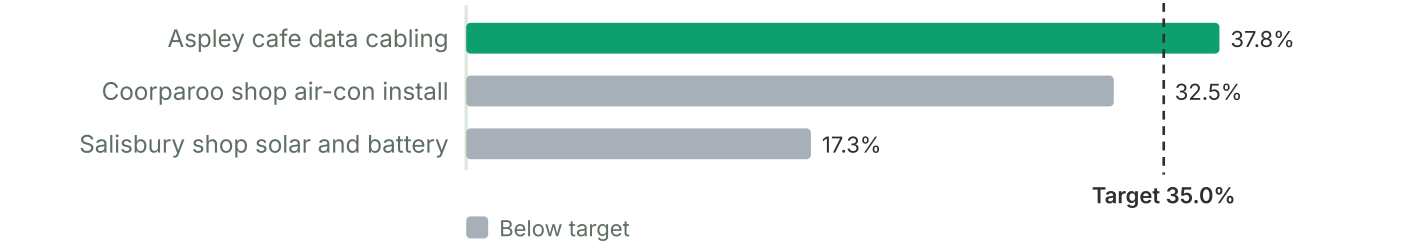
Job gross margin, October · Installations

26.1%

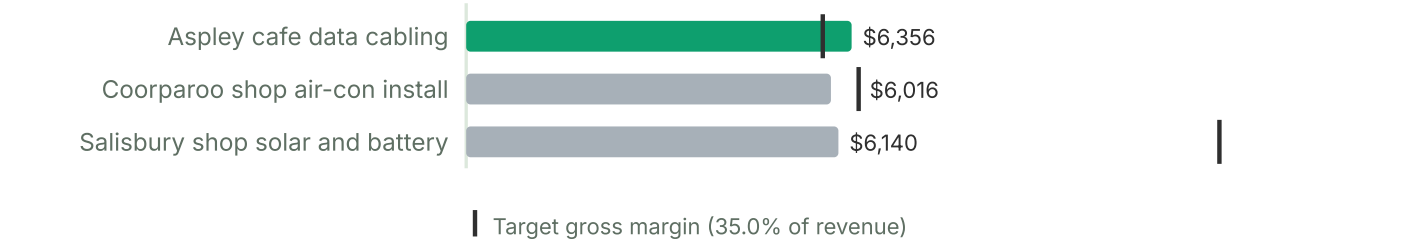
September 26.2%

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

2 of the 3 installation jobs invoiced in October made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Salisbury shop solar and battery made a 17.3% job gross margin: 120.0 h of technician time (\$8,160) and \$3,900 of subcontractors on a \$35,500 job. Jobs need 52.5% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Below the 52.5% overheads need: Aspley cafe data cabling (37.8%), Coorparoo shop air-con install (32.5%), Salisbury shop solar and battery (17.3%). Most profitable: Aspley cafe data cabling (37.8%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, October · Call-outs and repairs

43.3%

September 44.0%

Technician time charged, October

\$15,005

67.3% of call-out revenue

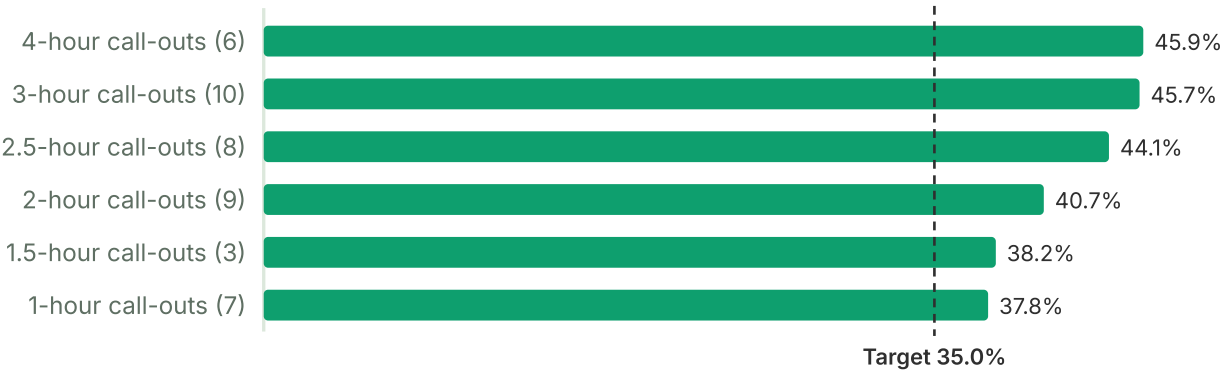
Materials charged, October

\$7,293

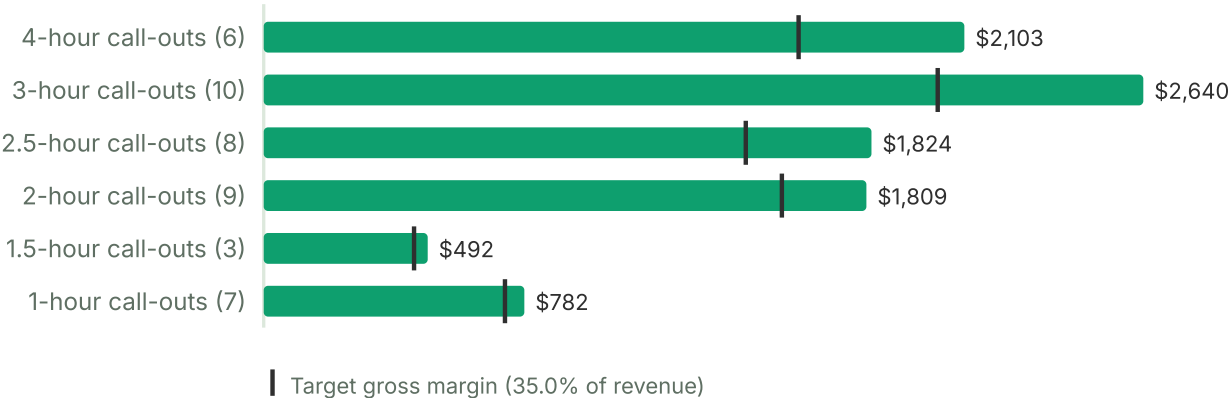
\$5,610 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

43 call-outs in October billed \$15,005 of technician time and \$7,293 of materials (\$5,610 at cost plus 30%), and made a 43.3% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 37.8% to 45.9% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

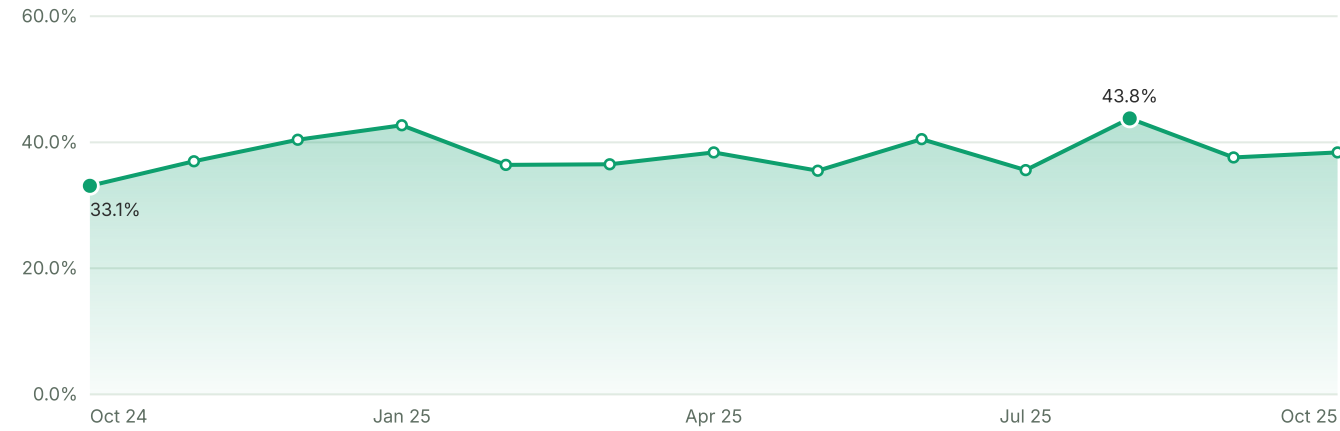
What you'd do about it

Call-outs: 43.3% gross margin, below the 52.5% needed to cover overheads.

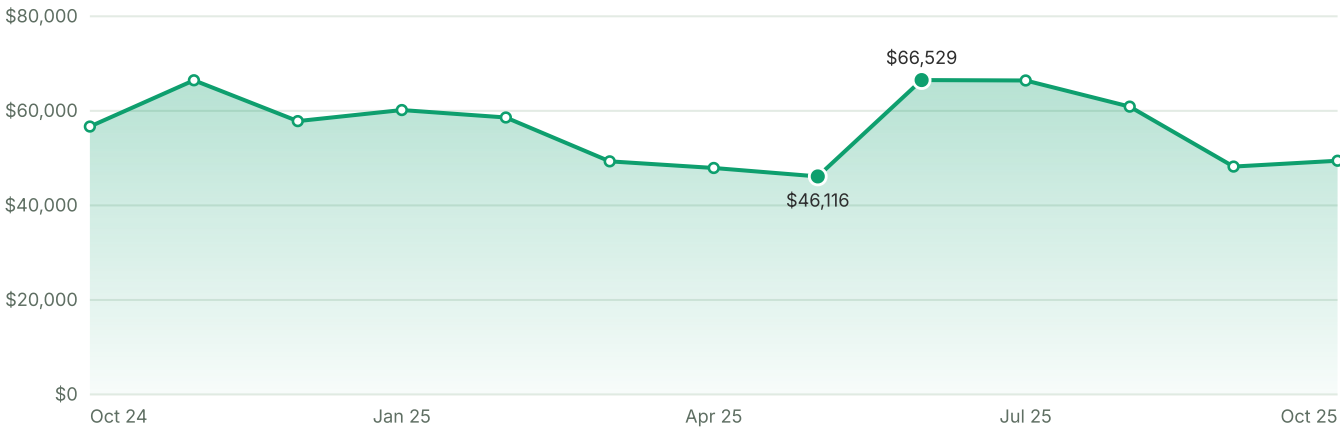
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.